

Function syntax – Building and Calling

You can define any number of functions in Python following certain rules. The first rule is to use the keyword *def* so that the program recognises that a function is being defined. This is followed by the function name and parentheses. You can place any arguments or input parameters inside these parentheses. There is no limit to the arguments or parameters you enter, just remember to separate them with a comma. Let's take a look at the syntax to be used for defining functions.

The *def* keyword is used to define any function. This is followed by the function name using the Python naming conventions and the parentheses for arguments or parameters and ended with colon ':'. This signifies the start of the code block.

The second line is optional and can be used to describe the function also known as *docstring*. Although optional, this is highly recommended as it will help you keep your functions neatly organised and easily understandable.

The last step is the output or the return expression. This is what you want to see when the function is called. Remember to follow the standard rules here. If there is any text enclose them in double inverted commas, “”, if there is any variable, use % symbol to define the variable. If there are no arguments given it will return the exact same line defined in the output function. You can check out the syntax here: <https://digit.in/FuncSyn> and some sample code here: <https://digit.in/FuncSam>.

To run the function, simply type in the function name with parentheses and hit enter. Continuing with the above code sample *bello* will return 'Hello User'. Also, for instance,

- ```
greeting_user("Fast Track reader", "how are you?")
```

Will return

- ```
Welcome Fast Track reader, how are you?
```

The argument in the function can also be linked to the output parameter and mixed with a constant. E.g.

- ```
def hello_name(fname):
```
- ```
    print("Hello " + fname)
```

Using this function as

- ```
hello_name("Mithun")
```

Will return

- ```
Hello Mithun
```

Another option is to use a default parameter value which can also be substituted with a variable